to the metre range. The Galileo constellation in space will comprise 30 satellites in total. There will be 24 operational satellites, plus 6 spare satellites, circulating in medium Earth orbit on three orbital planes.

BEIDOU (China)

BeiDou Navigation Satellite System (BDS) is a Chinese satellite Navigation system. It consists of two separate satellite constellations. The first BeiDou system is officially called the BeiDou Satellite Navigation Experimental System and also known as BeiDou-1.

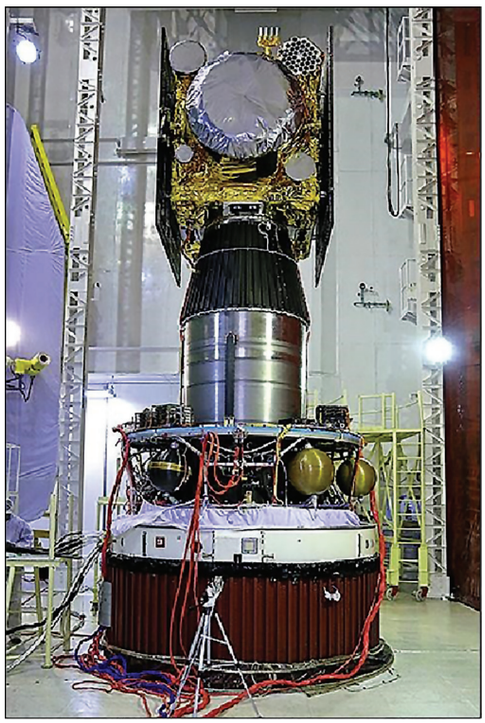
On December 27, 2018, Beidou-3 officially began to provide global services. The Beidou-3M/G/I satellites represent the orbital segment of the third phase of the Chinese Beidou navigation system which uses satellites in Medium Earth Orbit and Geosynchronous Orbit and is also known as the Compass Navigation Satellite System.

Japan Aerospace Exploration Agency (QZSS Japan)

QZSS is a regional navigation satellite system that provides service to Japan and the Asia-Oceania region. QZSS (nickname of Michibiki - meaning to 'guide' or 'show the way') QZSS is a Japanese satellite positioning system composed mainly of satellites in quasi-zenith orbits (QZO). However, the term "Quasi-Zenith Satellite (QZS)" can refer to both satellites in QZO and geostationary orbits (GEO). For that reason, the name "QZO satellite" is used when it is necessary to specifically refer to satellites in QZO. Satellite positioning systems use satellite signals to calculate position information. The QZSS is sometimes called the "Japanese GPS."

IRNSS (Indian Regional Navigational Satellite System)

IRNSS is an autonomous regional satellite navigation system being developed by ISRO (Indian Space Research Organization). It is designed to provide geospatial positioning information within the Indian sub-continent. It enables users to map out their location (altitude, longitude and latitude). The objective of developing IRNSS was to cut down India's dependency on foreign navigation satellite systems.



It provides location information service to users in India and the region extending for up to 1,500 km from the Indian boundary. This is the primary service area of IRNSS information service to users in India and the region extending up to 1500 km from Indian boundary.

IRNSS aims to provide the following services:

1. Standard Positioning Service (SPS) for civilian, research & commercial use,
2. Restricted Service (RS) for authorized users. For example in defence, IRNSS is used for ground, aerial and marine navigation, disaster management, mobile phone integration, mapping and visual & voice navigation for drivers, among others.

TN_GOVT_XII_Geography_chapter 06.indd 124 12/10/2021 11:55:51 AM